

**RY BAAS IS
BACK IN
TOWN**

MDW 12-18 APRIL 2027

TRIENNALE, MILAN

**”DESIGNERS IN MILAN
ARE LIKE CLOWNS PERFORMING
FOR AN AUDIENCE THAT JUST
WANTS TO BE ENTERTAINED.
INSTEAD OF HIDING IT BEHIND
CLEAN GALLERY WALLS,
I WANTED TO PUT THE
CIRCUS RIGHT IN YOUR FACE.”**

Marteen Baas

BAAS IN TOWN - FUORISALONE 2014

During MDW 2014, dutch designer **Maarten Baas** design a solo show ***Baas is in Town***: an immersive indoor circus located at Garage Sanremo in the neighbourhood Cinque Vie.

Baas aimed to expose the ***circus*** that Milan Design Week had become: retail-ready products matters less than capturing the **perfect snapshot** for Facebook likes.

BAAS IN TOWN - FUORISALONE 2014



BAAS IN TOWN - FUORISALONE 2014

To **provoke** visitors Baas intentionally mixed improvised, taped-together **polystyrene models** destined for the trash with **highly valuable collections**,

Some actors were dressed as **clowns** and **performed** inside booths built against the walls.

WHY WE CHOSE THIS EXHIBITION

As young designers based in Milan, we visit MDW every year, and each time we become increasingly aware of the obsession with **oversharing** and the **superficiality** of people entering these design exhibitions.

We felt that Baas's initial intuition about the Design Week circus in 2014 needed to be **updated** and restaged after a 12 year evolution of social media.



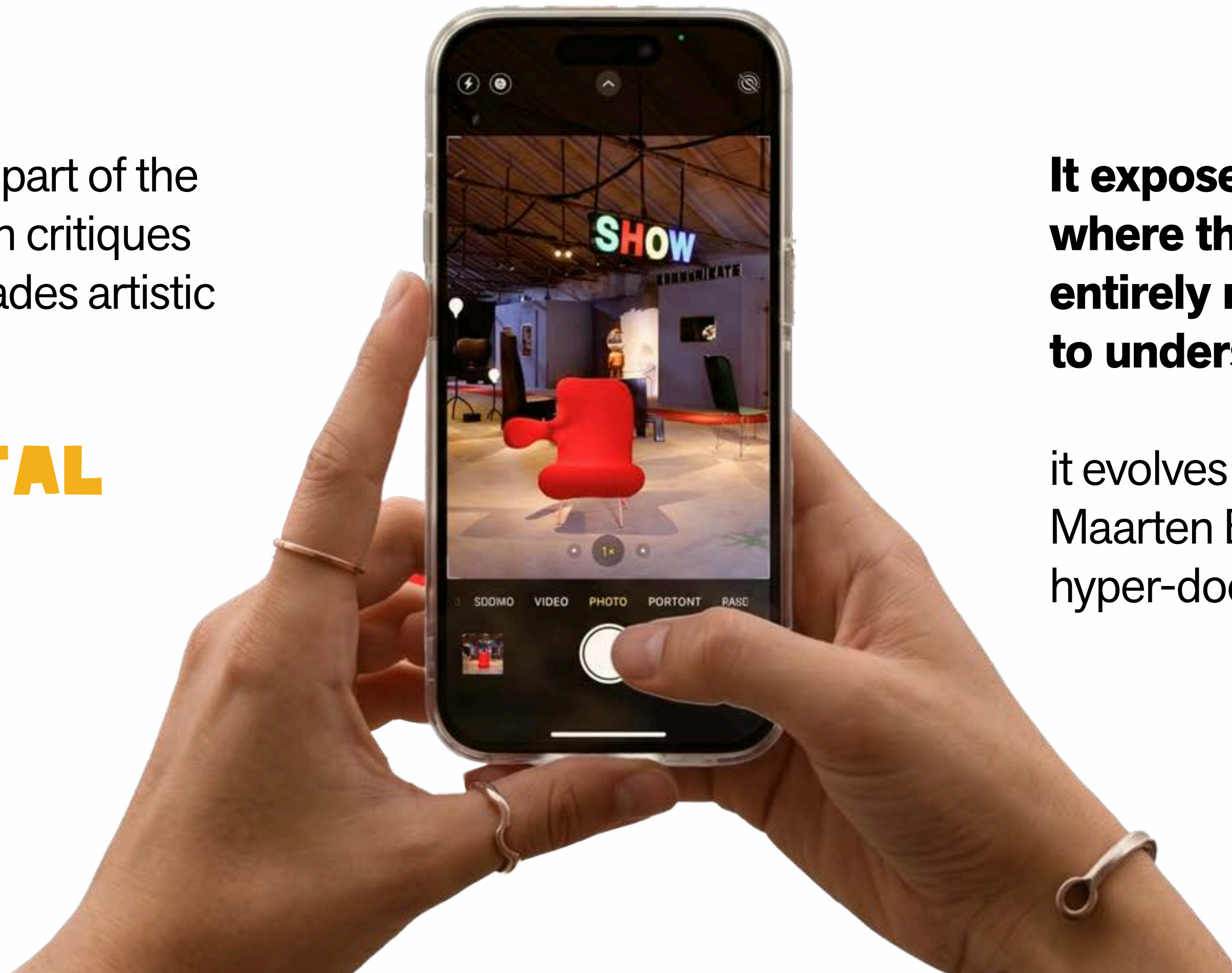


**THE SHOW IS ON.
AND YOU ARE THE MAIN ACT.**

CONCEPT

Transforming spectators into part of the actual exhibits, this installation critiques how **Milan Design Week** trades artistic substance for

SHALLOW DIGITAL SPECTACLE.



It exposes a semantic vacuum where the reflex to share has entirely replaced the will to understand,

it evolves a discourse initiated by Maarten Baas in 2014 against hyper-documentation.



tone of voice

PLAYFUL ARROGANCE

Bold, direct, and slightly **provocative**.

RAW SINCERITY

Calling out social media behavior using childlike, unfiltered honesty (matching the raw look of your custom clay font).

UNRELENTING SARCASM

Treating the **viewer** not as a design enthusiast, but as a **content creator** looking for a backdrop.

OOOH CAMPAIGN



POSTER



CUSTOM TRAM



POSTER



MINI-POSTER



POSTER



BILLBOARD



ENTRANCE

Inspired by Baas' signature cardboard letters the front of Triennale is decorated by the exhibition's ad. Mirrors evoke the core concept: **you are the show.**



EVENT REGISTRATION LANDING PAGE

This **event registration landing page** follows the standard **QR-based access system** used across Milan Design Week events.



EVENT REGISTRATION LANDING PAGE

Visitors enter their **details**, accept the **privacy notice** and can opt in to **updates** from Maarten Baas.

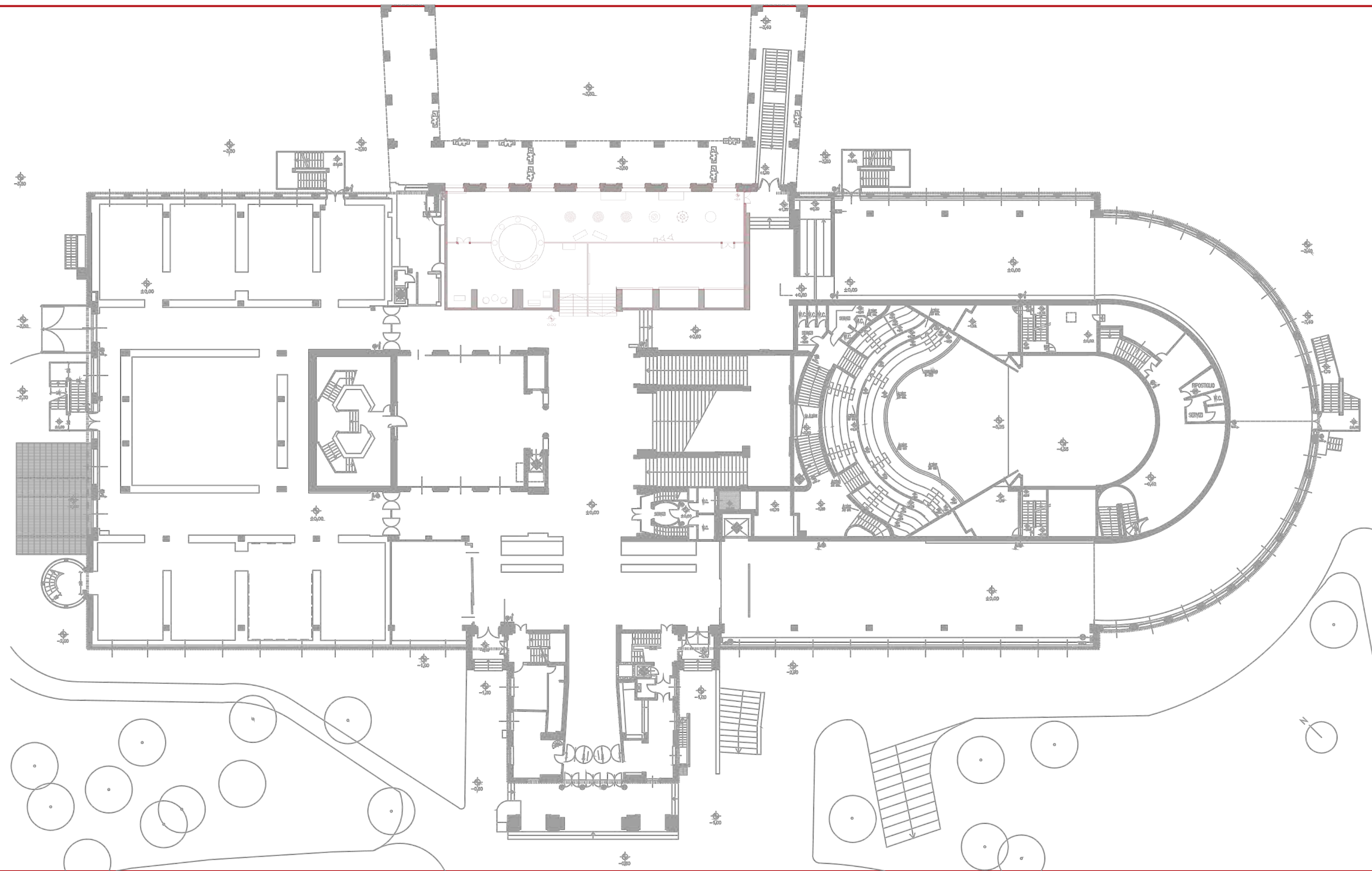
The page clearly informs users that **registering** means taking part in an event where they will be **filmed or photographed**. Once completed, the page generates their **entry pass**.

The image displays two mobile phone screens side-by-side, both showing a red-themed event registration form. The top status bar on both phones shows the time as 9:41 and signal/battery icons. The left phone screen shows the 'VISITOR REGISTRATION' title, a sub-header 'Complete the required information to generate your entry pass.', and input fields for 'First Name *', 'Last Name *', and 'Email *'. Below these are sections for 'Profession *' (with a 'Select your profession' button), 'Company / Studio' (with a 'Company or studio' button), and 'Privacy & consent'. The right phone screen shows the 'Profession *' and 'Company / Studio' sections, followed by the 'Privacy & consent' section with two checkboxes: 'I have read the Privacy Notice for event registration*' and 'Keep me updated on future events and projects by Maarten Baas'. Below the checkboxes is a camera icon and text stating 'Filming and photography are part of this exhibition. By registering, you agree to be photographed and filmed during the experience.' At the bottom of both screens is a large yellow button labeled 'GET MY PASS' and a mobile browser navigation bar with a back arrow, the URL 'maartenbaas.com', a refresh icon, and a menu icon.



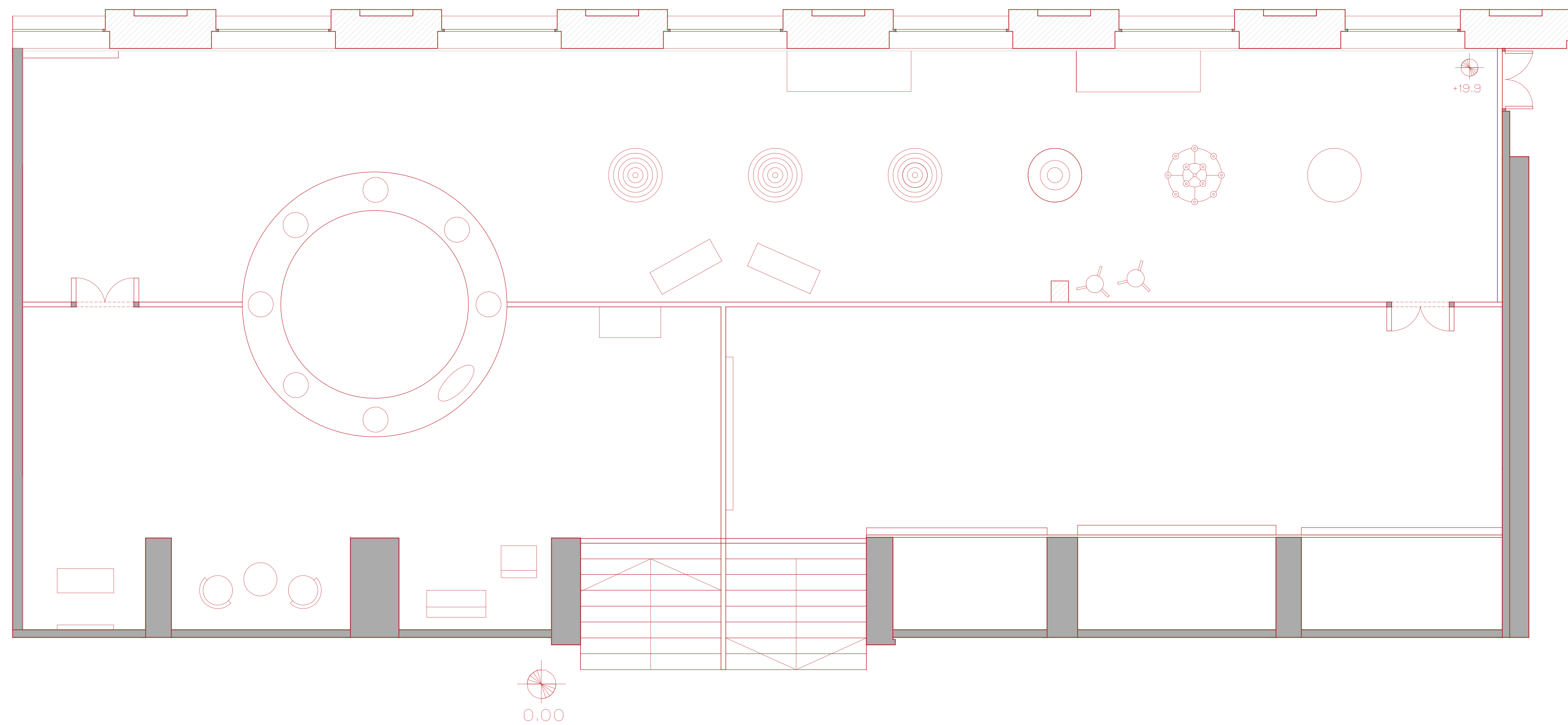


GENERAL PLAN



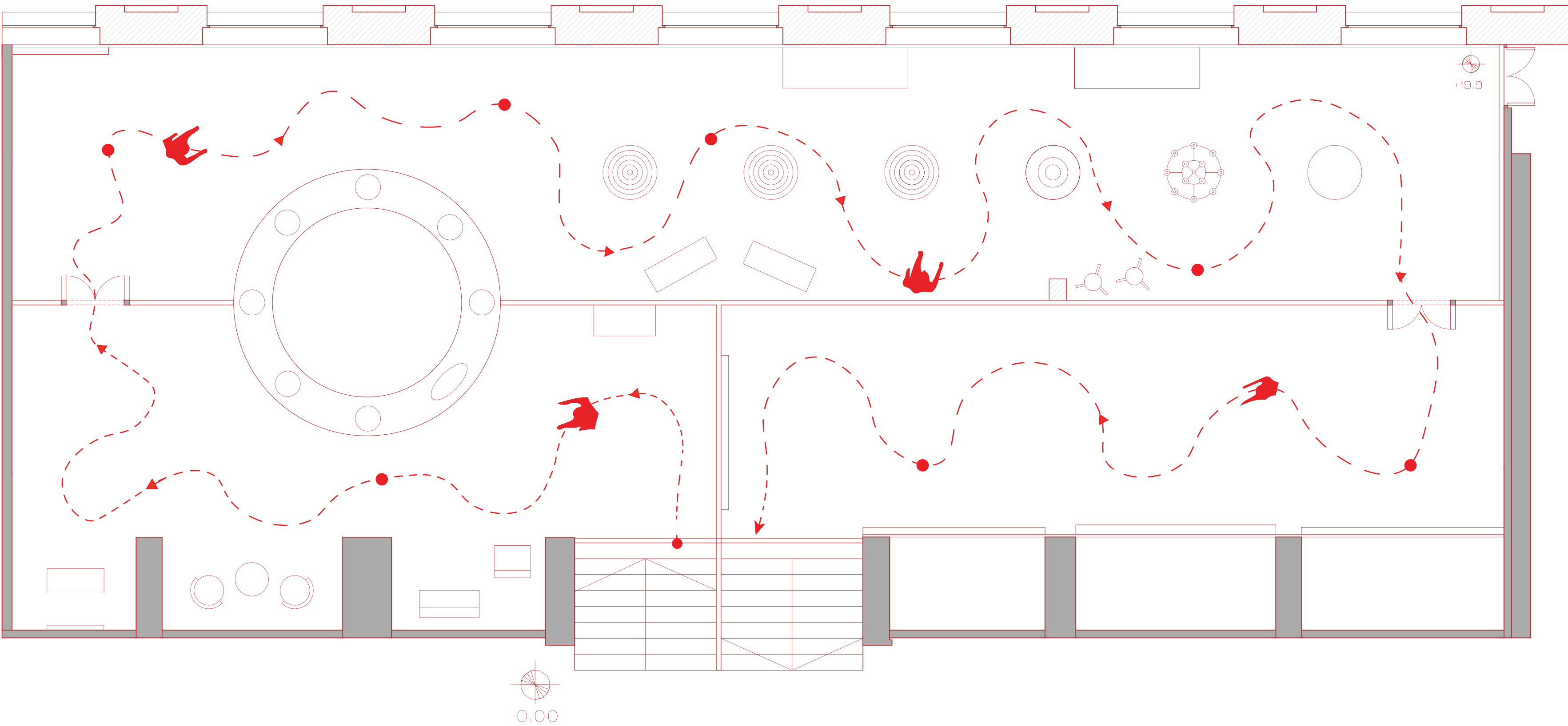
1:350

EXHIBITION PLAN



1:80

PLANNED FLOW



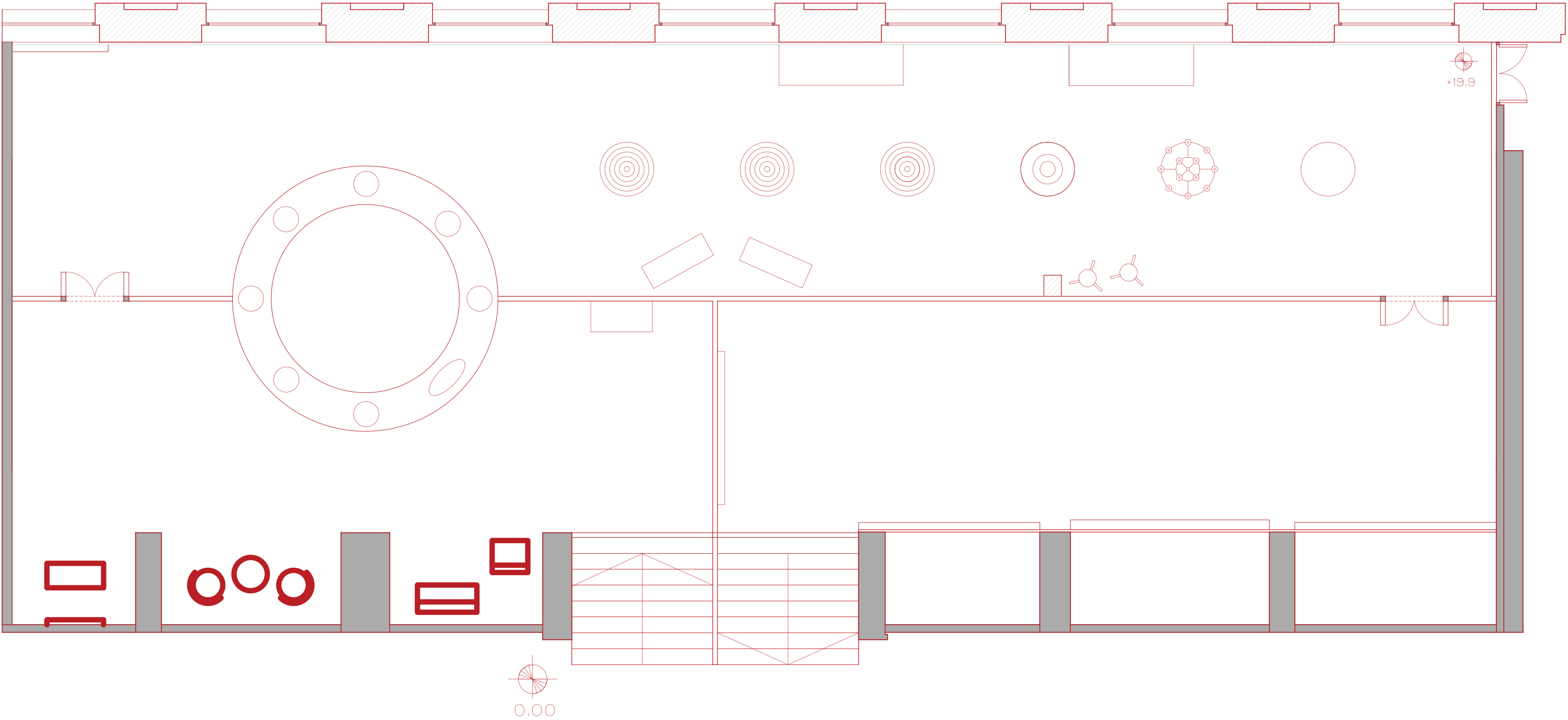
1:80

WAYFINDING



THE ITEMS

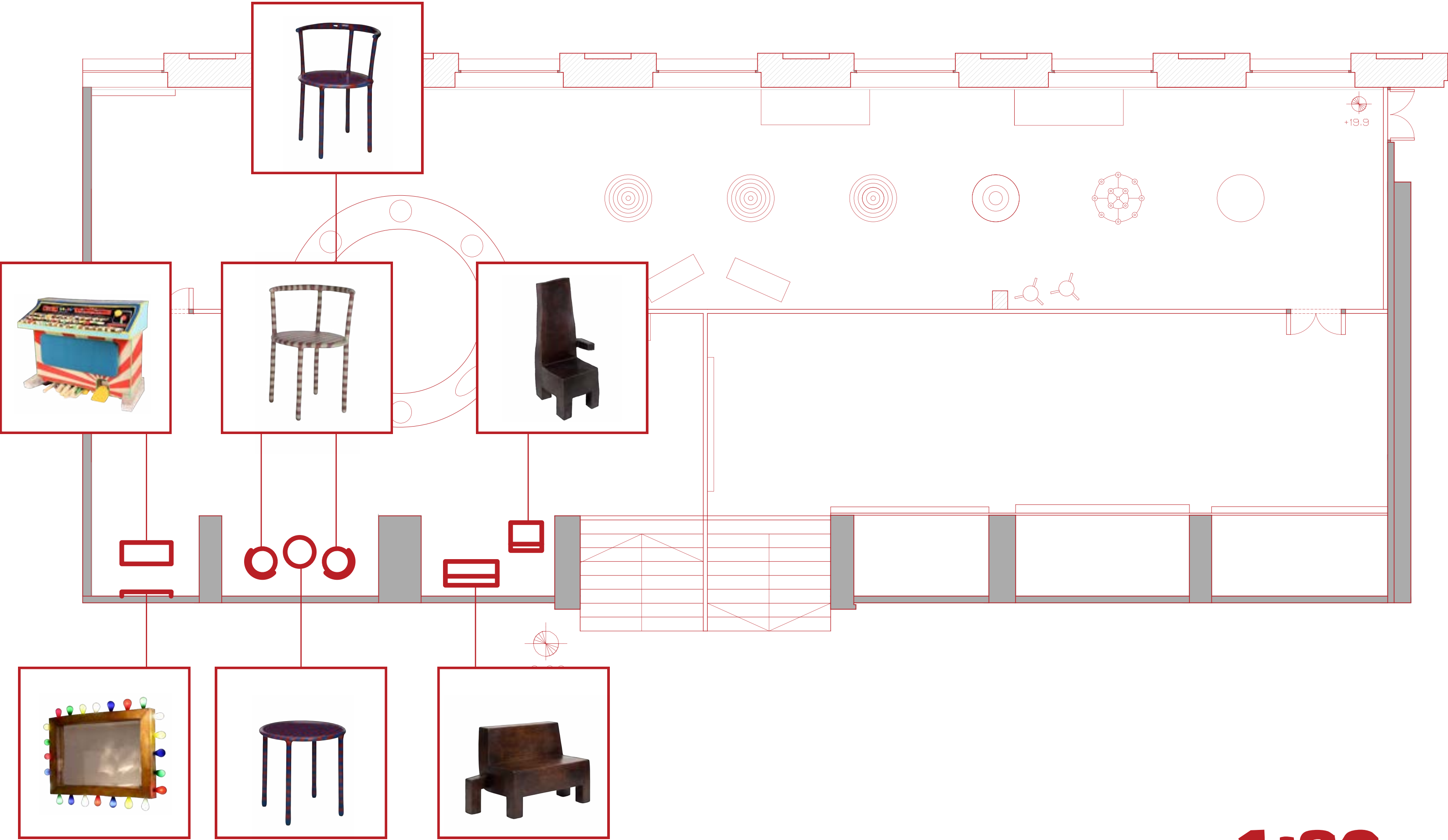
THE THREE RECESSES



1:90

THE ITEMS

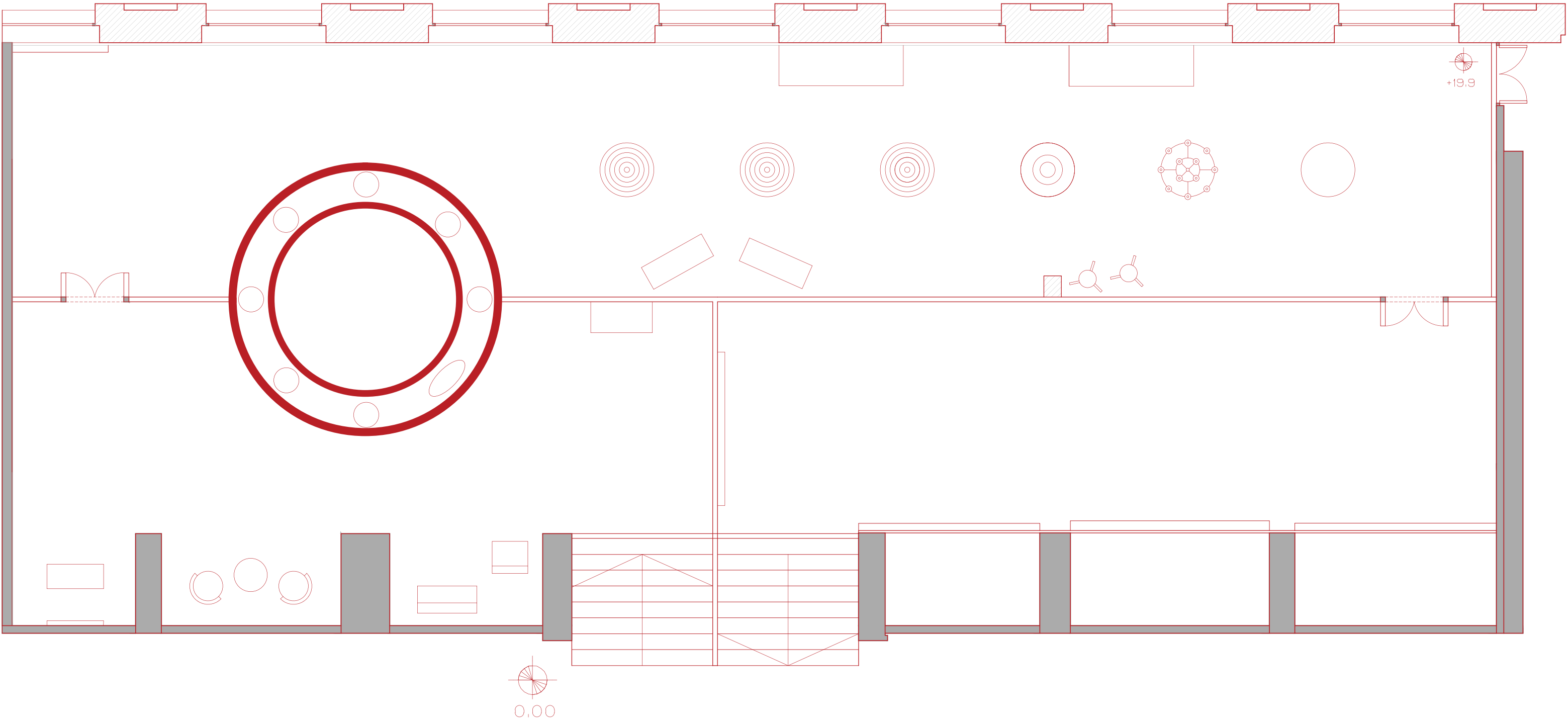
THE THREE RECESSES



1:90

THE ITEMS

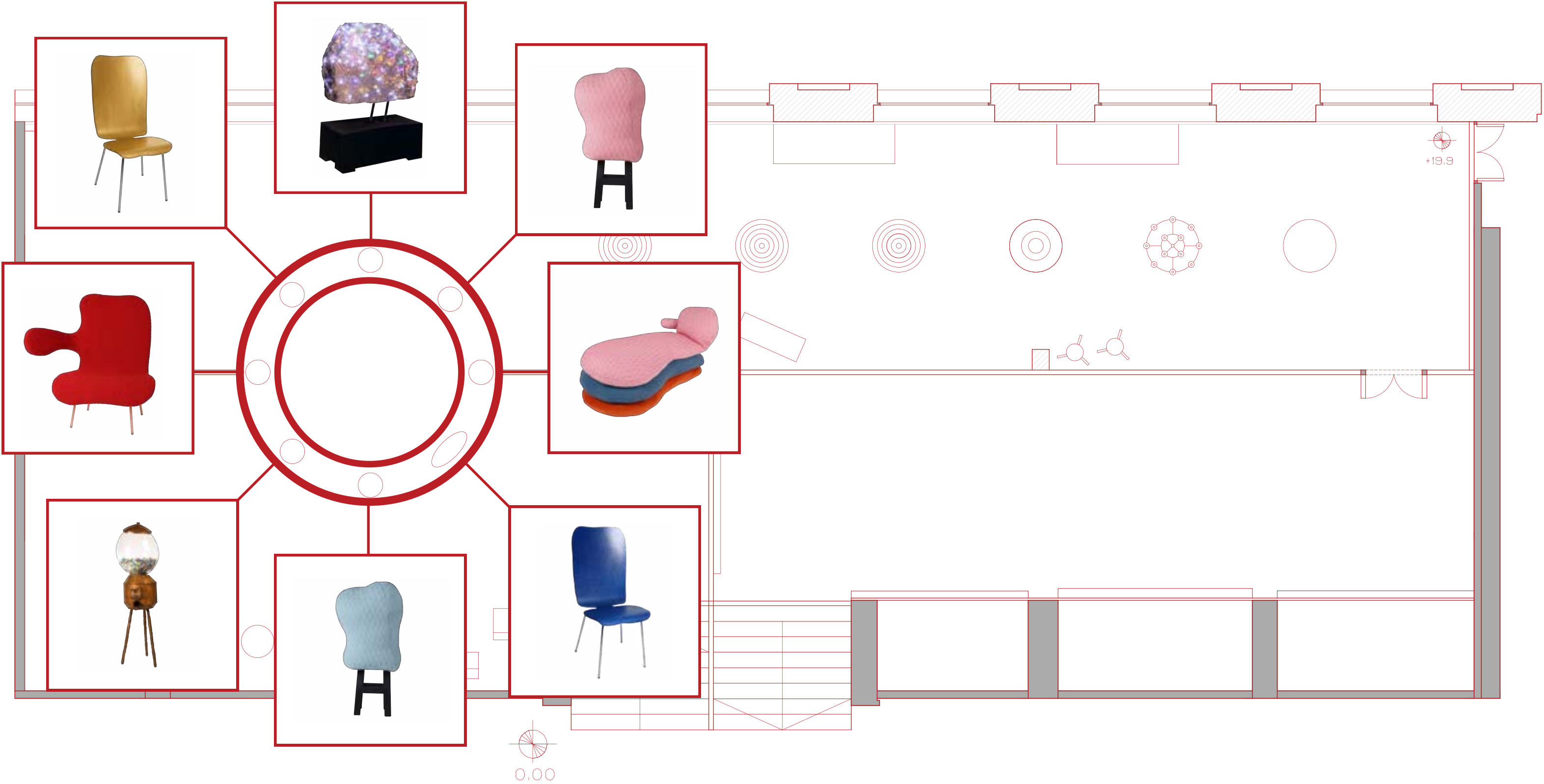
THE SHOW CAROUSEL



1:90

THE ITEMS

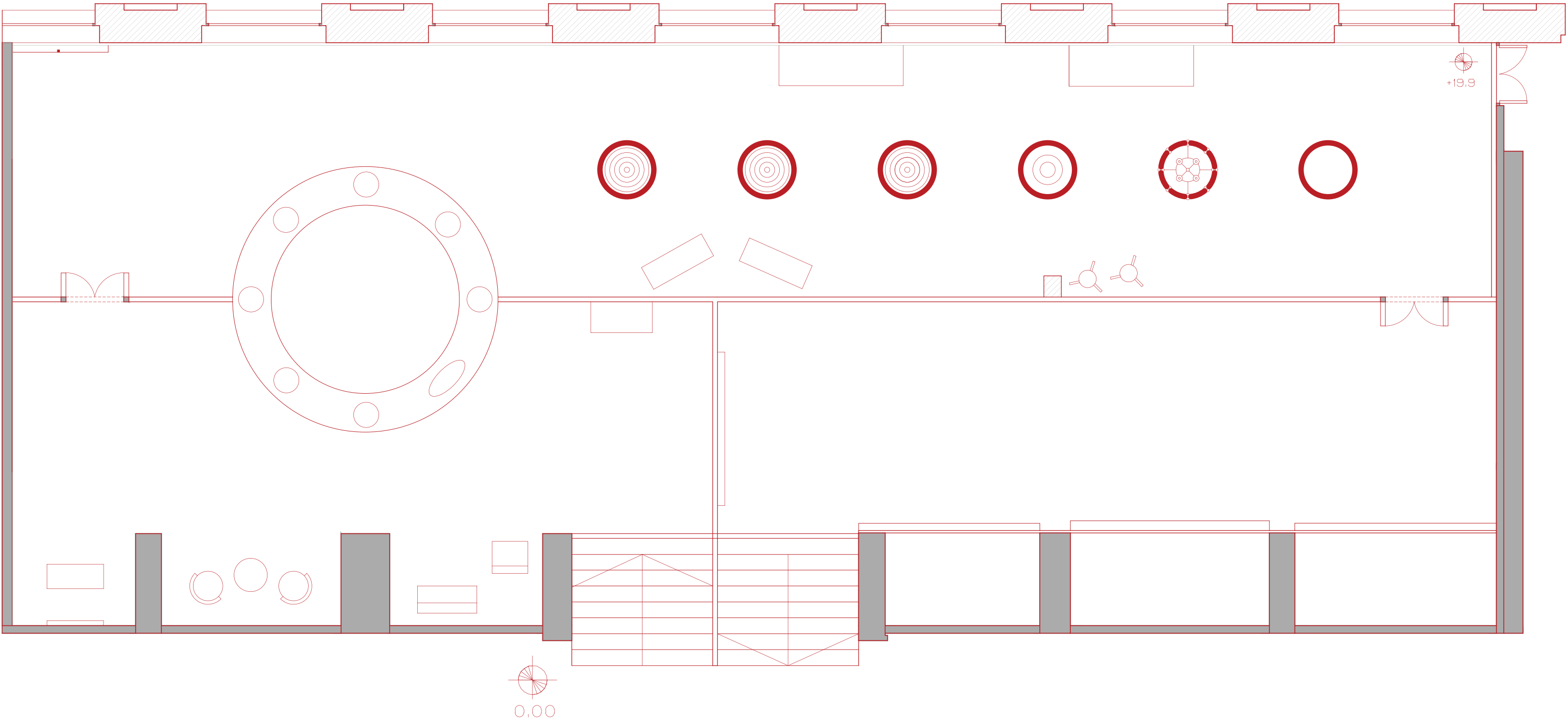
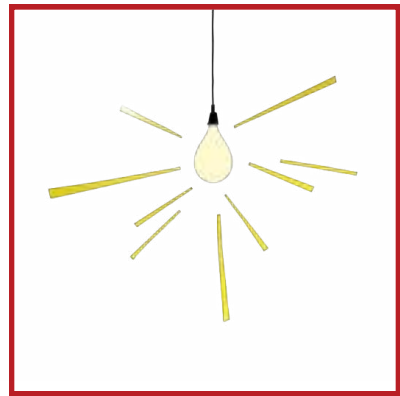
THE SHOW CAROUSEL



1:90

THE ITEMS

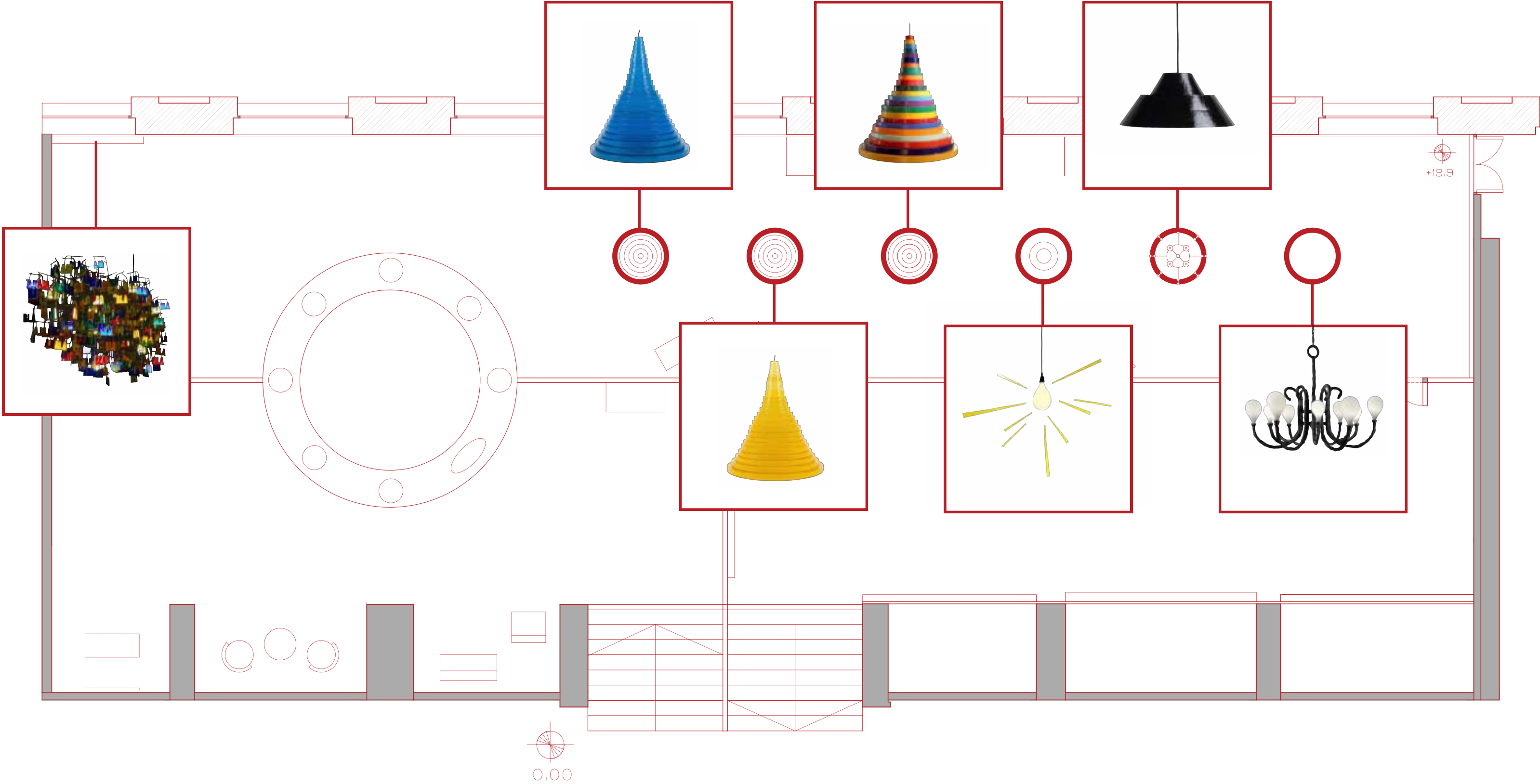
THE CHANDELIERS' HALLWAY



1:90

THE ITEMS

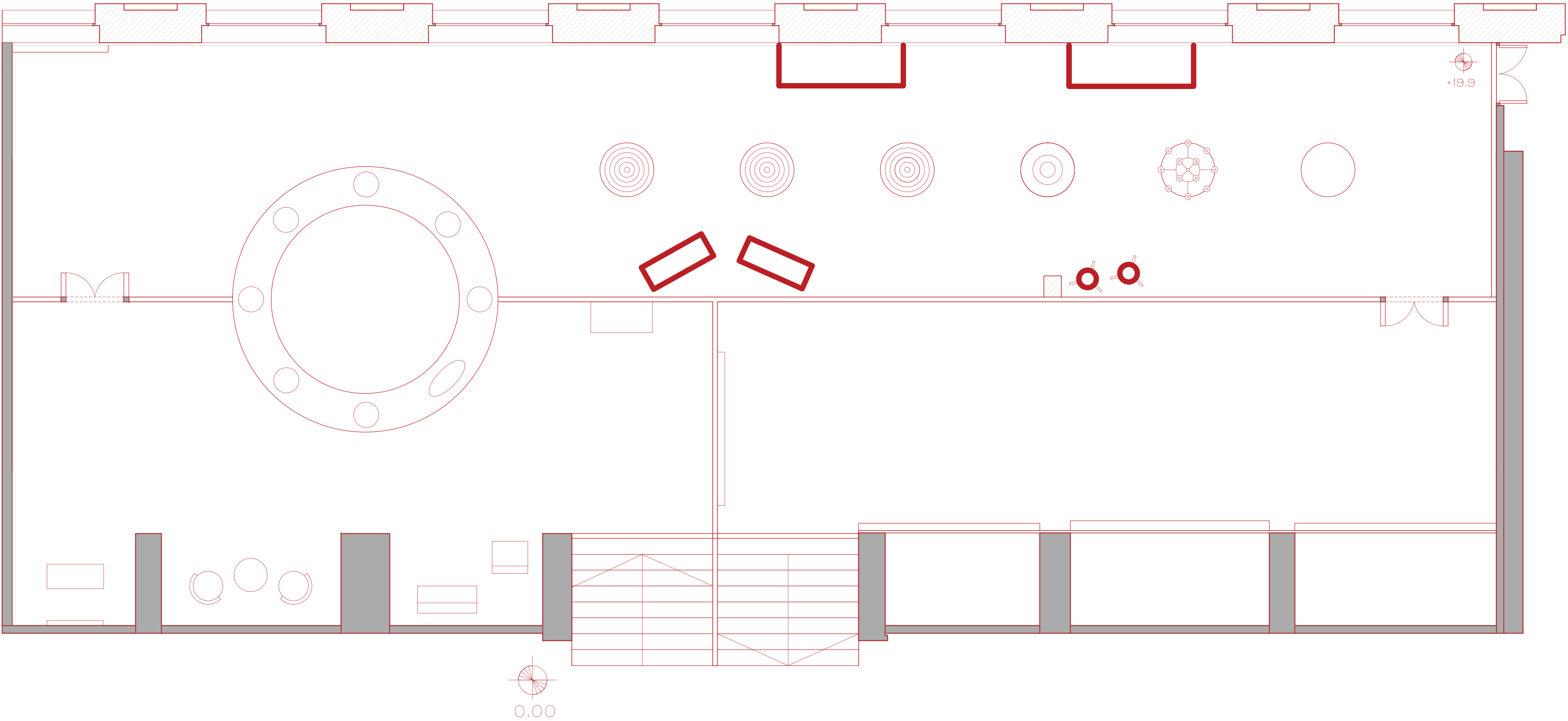
THE CHANDELIERS' HALLWAY



1:90

THE ITEMS

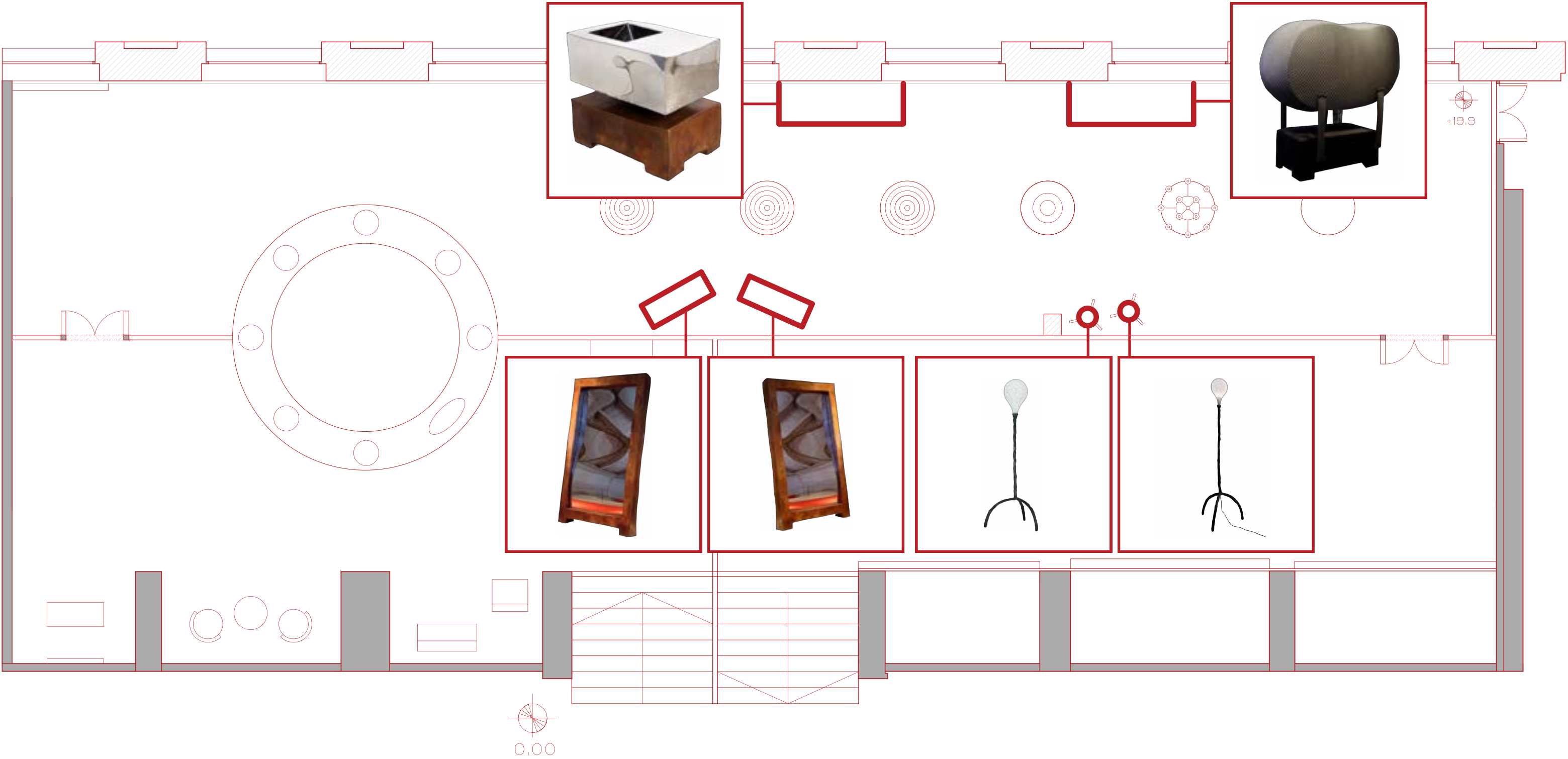
THE CHANDELIERS' HALLWAY



1:90

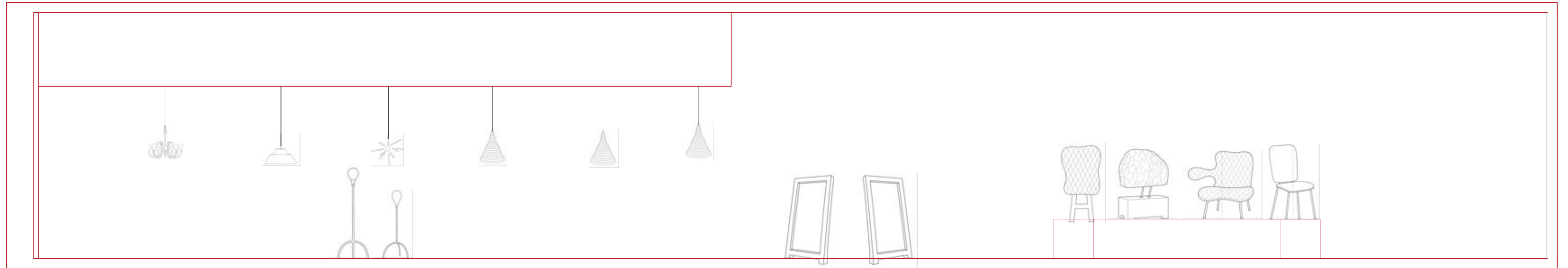
THE ITEMS

THE CHANDELIERS' HALLWAY



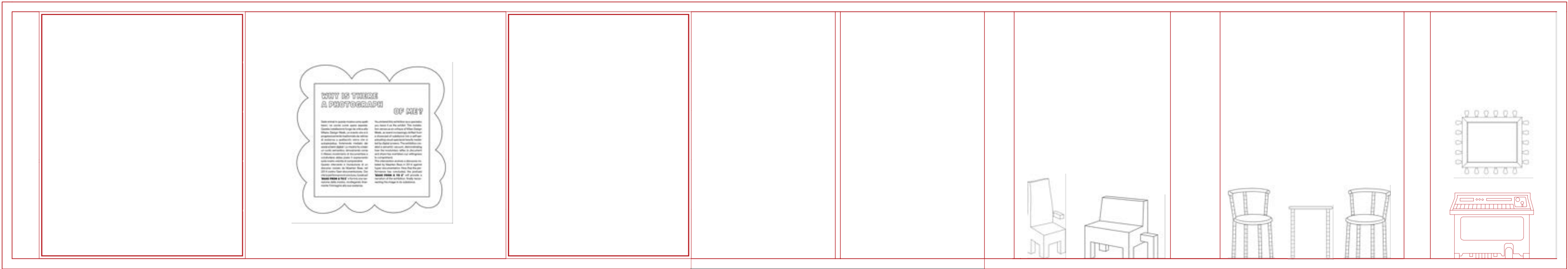
1:90

SECTIONS



1:60

SECTIONS



1:60

3D RENDERINGS: MAIN AREA A



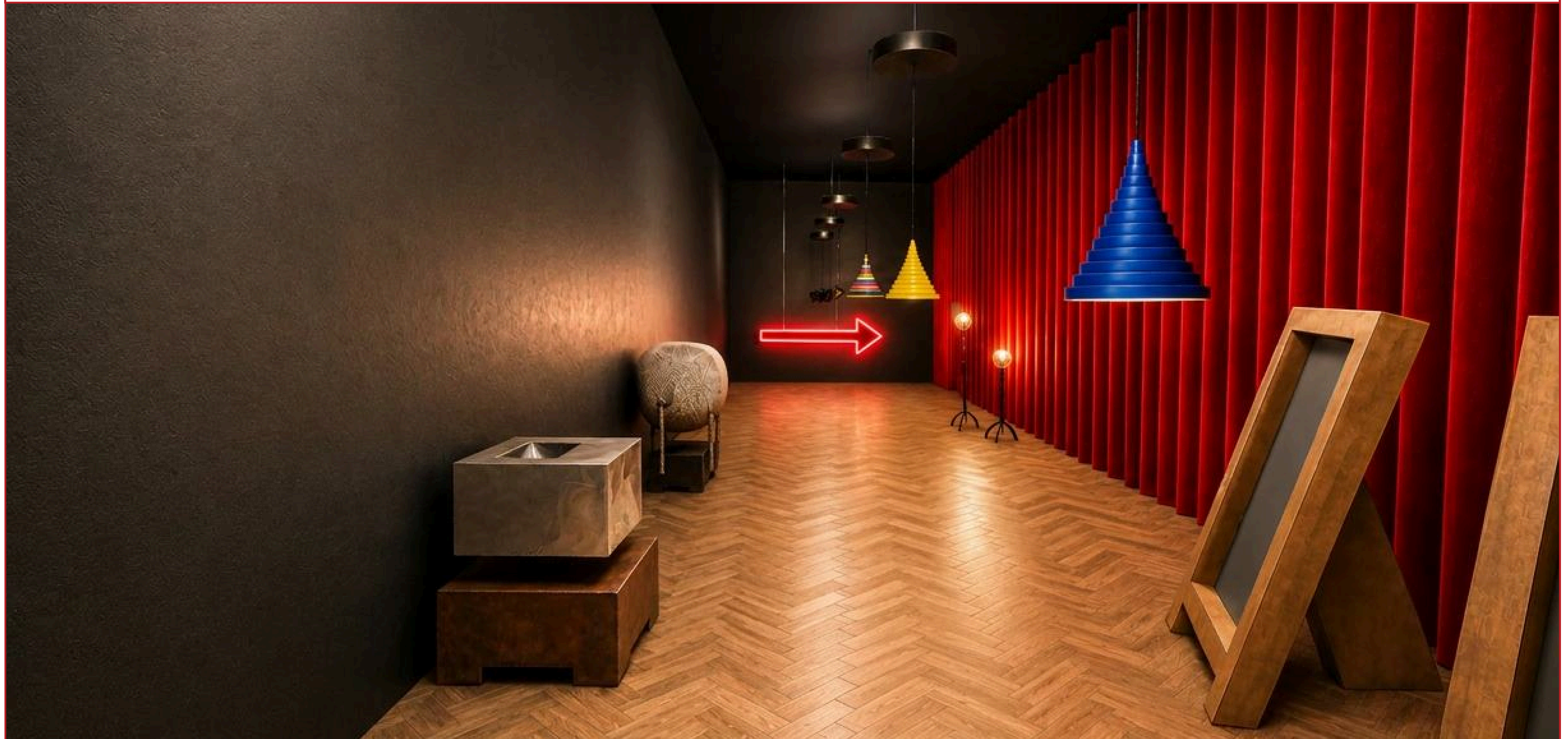
3D RENDERINGS: MAIN AREA A



3D RENDERINGS: DISPLAYS



3D RENDERINGS: MAIN AREA A

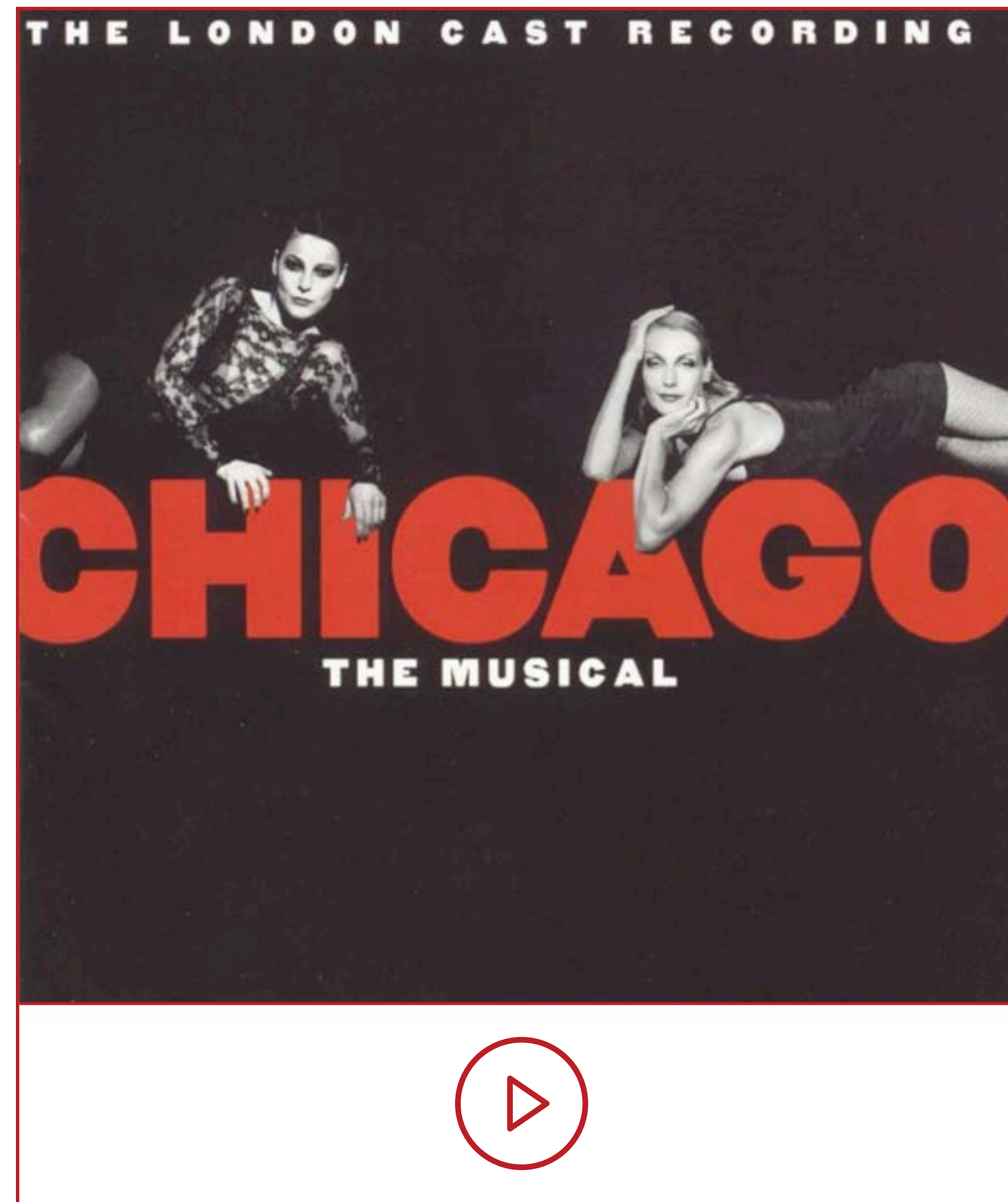


DETAILS

BACKGROUND MUSIC

While the 2014 exhibition had a chaotic music in the background, this restage adopts the **broadway mood** of the Chicago Overture to match the **theatrical setup**.

This choice moves away from the circus vibe and leans into the energy of a show production.



WHY NO LABELS?

LABELS are not part of BAAS' disruptive way of displaying its works.



IN THIS PARTICULAR EXHIBITION
if labels were present they would invalidate the main
CRITIQUE about the visitors

DETAILS

THE MOCKING ACTORS

To enhance the provocation, we have decided to position **actors dressed as clowns** throughout the space. Wearing an exaggerated number of tote bags and constantly **taking pictures** of the exhibits, they actively **mock the visitors' behaviour**.



DETAILS





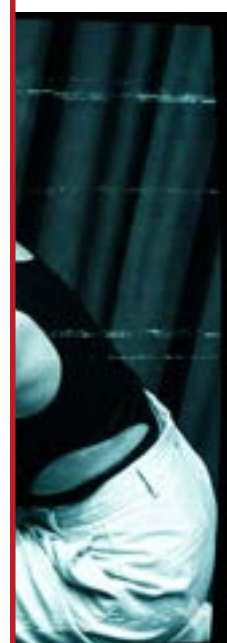
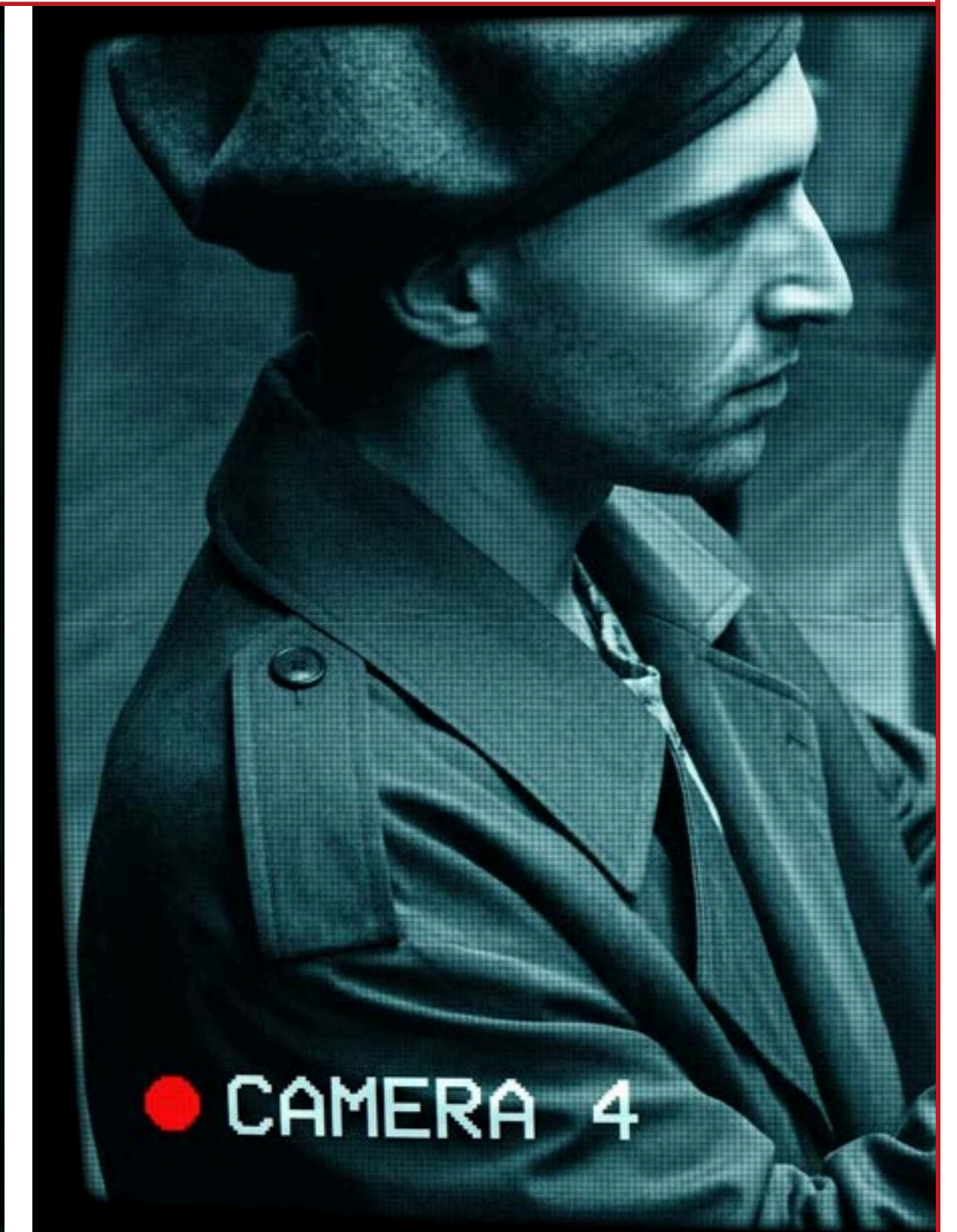
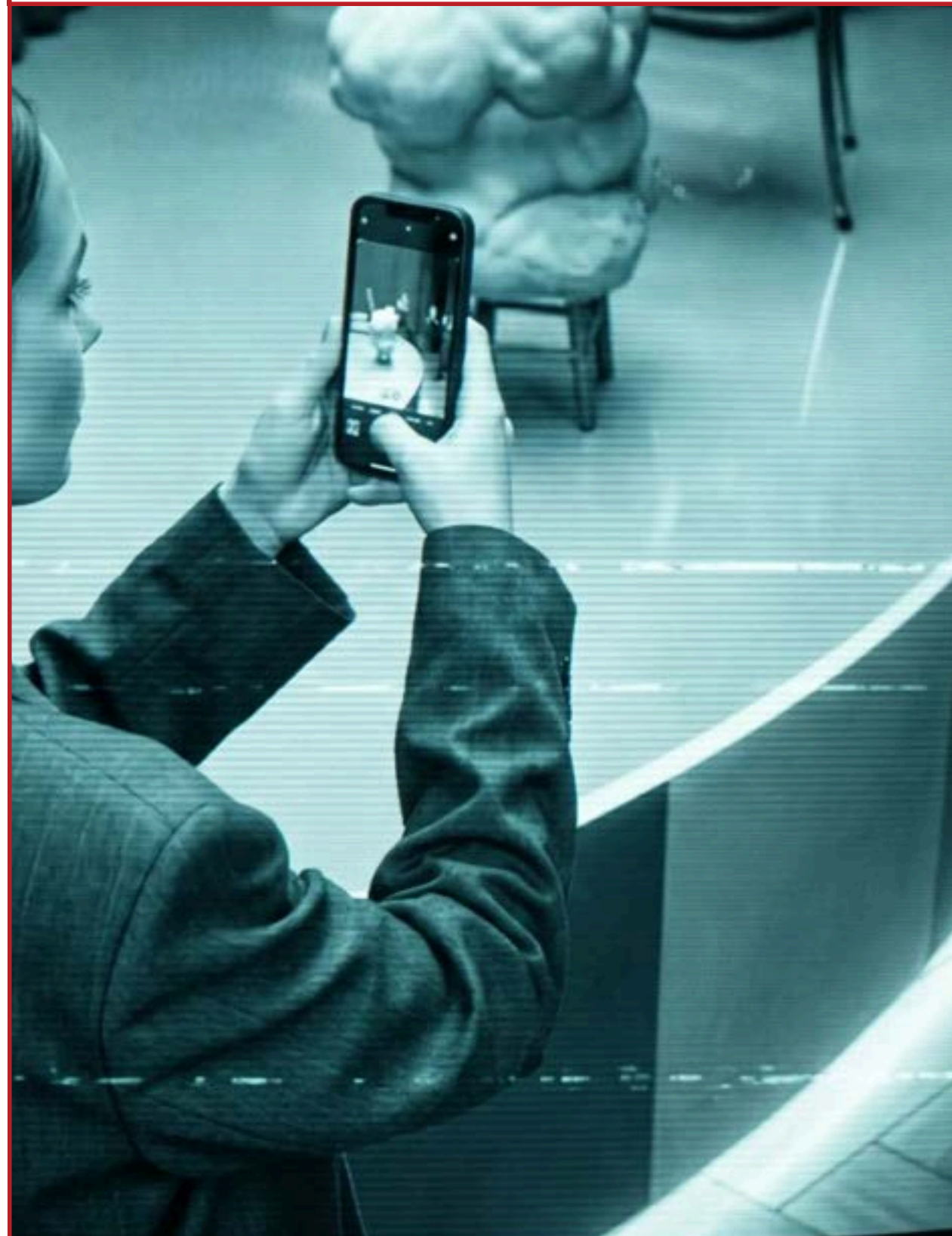
BACKSTAGE

THE SHOW
MUST
GO ON

BACKSTAGE



SECURITY CAMERAS



BACKSTAGE



TEXT FONT:
AKZIDENZ GROTESK

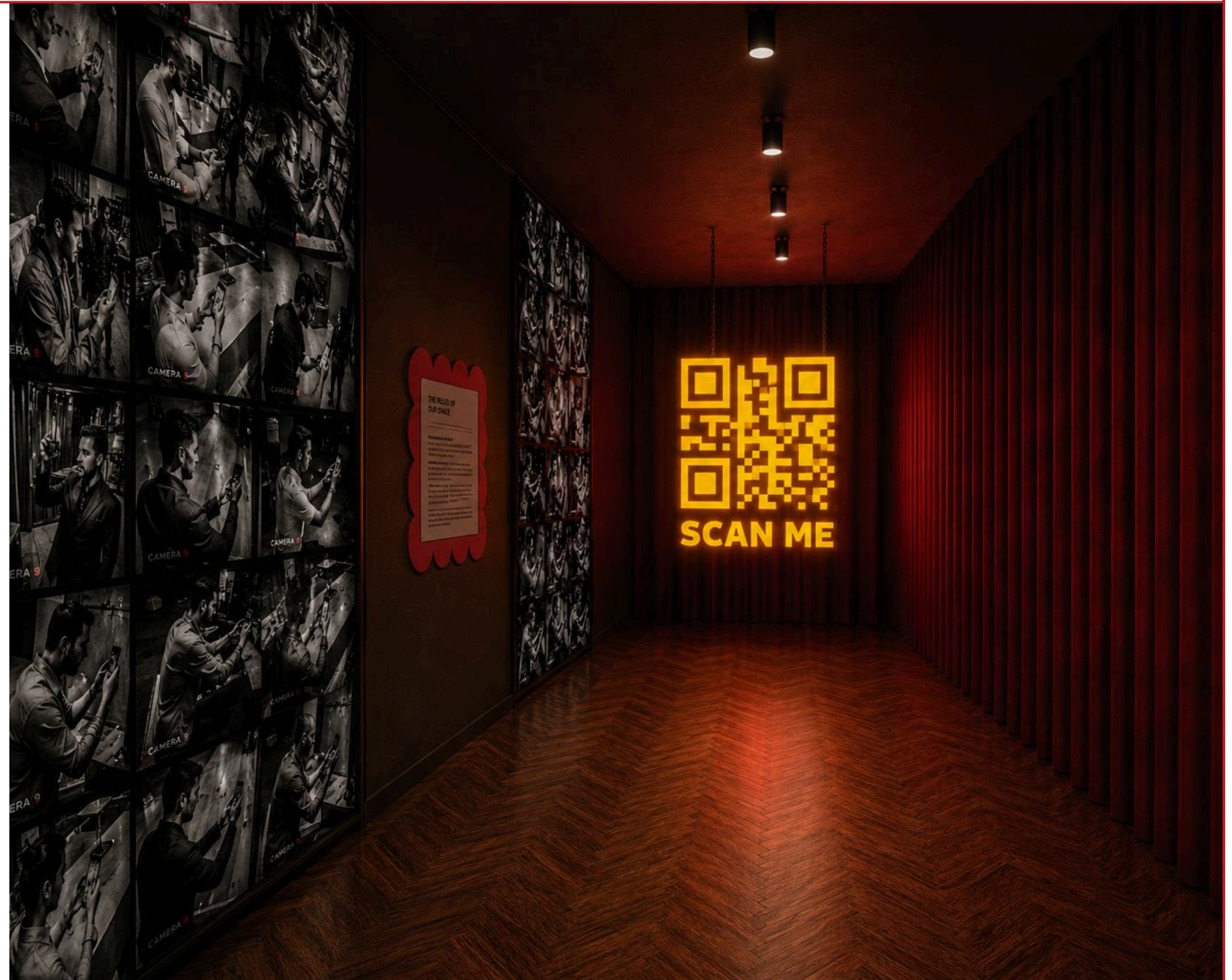
TEXT SIZE:
80 PT

WHY IS THERE A PHOTOGRAPH OF ME?

Siete entrati in questa mostra come spettatori, ne uscite come opere esposte. Questa installazione funge da critica alla Milano Design Week, un evento che si è progressivamente trasformato da vetrina di sostanza a spettacolo visivo che si autoperpetua, fortemente mediato dagli schermi digitali. La mostra ha creato un vuoto semantico, dimostrando come il riflesso involontario di documentare e condividere abbia preso il sopravvento sulla nostra volontà di comprendere. Questo intervento è l'evoluzione di un discorso iniziato da Maarten Baas nel 2014 contro l'iper-documentazione. Ora che la performance è conclusa, il podcast **"BAAS FROM A TO Z"** vi fornirà una narrazione della mostra, ricollegando finalmente l'immagine alla sua sostanza.

You entered this exhibition as a spectator, you leave it as the exhibit. This installation serves as an critique of Milan Design Week, an event increasingly shifted from a showcase of substance into a self-perpetuating visual spectacle heavily mediated by digital screens. The exhibition created a semantic vacuum, demonstrating how the involuntary reflex to document and share has overtaken our willingness to comprehend. This intervention evolves a discourse initiated by Maarten Baas in 2014 against hyper-documentation. Now that the performance has concluded, the podcast **"BAAS FROM A TO Z"** will provide a narration of the exhibition, finally reconnecting the image to its substance.

BACKSTAGE



PODCAST: BAAS FROM A TO Z



PODCAST IDEA

The idea came from the words of Marteen Baas, in particular a quote from a 2014's interview:

*"The starting point was to emphasise the circus that Milan is and also that things are very much about showing nice pictures. It hardly makes sense to develop a piece **from A to Z** and then present it in Milan because in the end it's nothing more than a snapshot to share on Facebook or whatever."*

EPISODE 1

A is for Archive: Resurrecting the Circus

EPISODE 2

C is for Curtain: Staging the Void

EPISODE 3

M is for Movement: The Show Carousel

EPISODE 4

I is for Illusion: Distortions and Glow

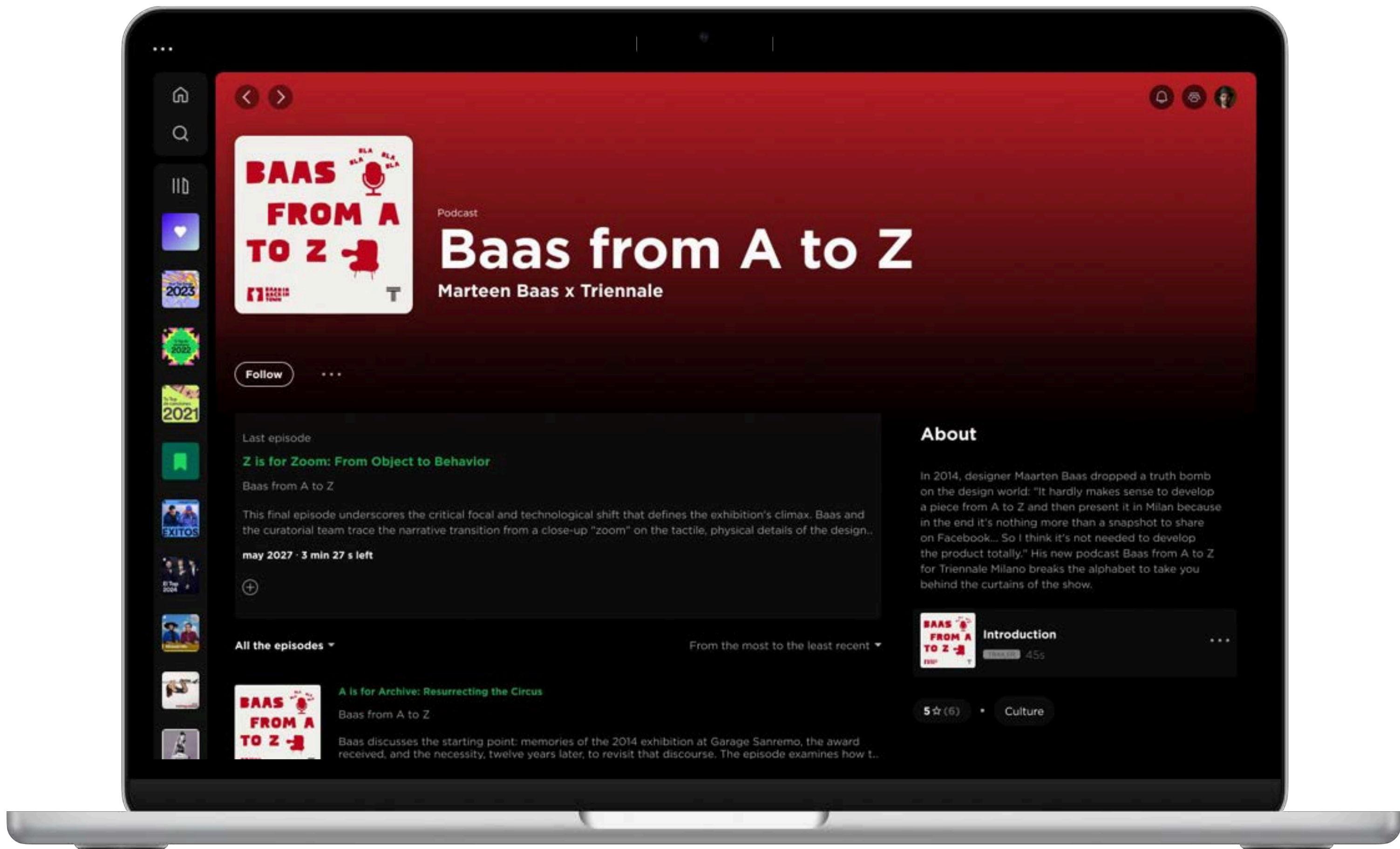
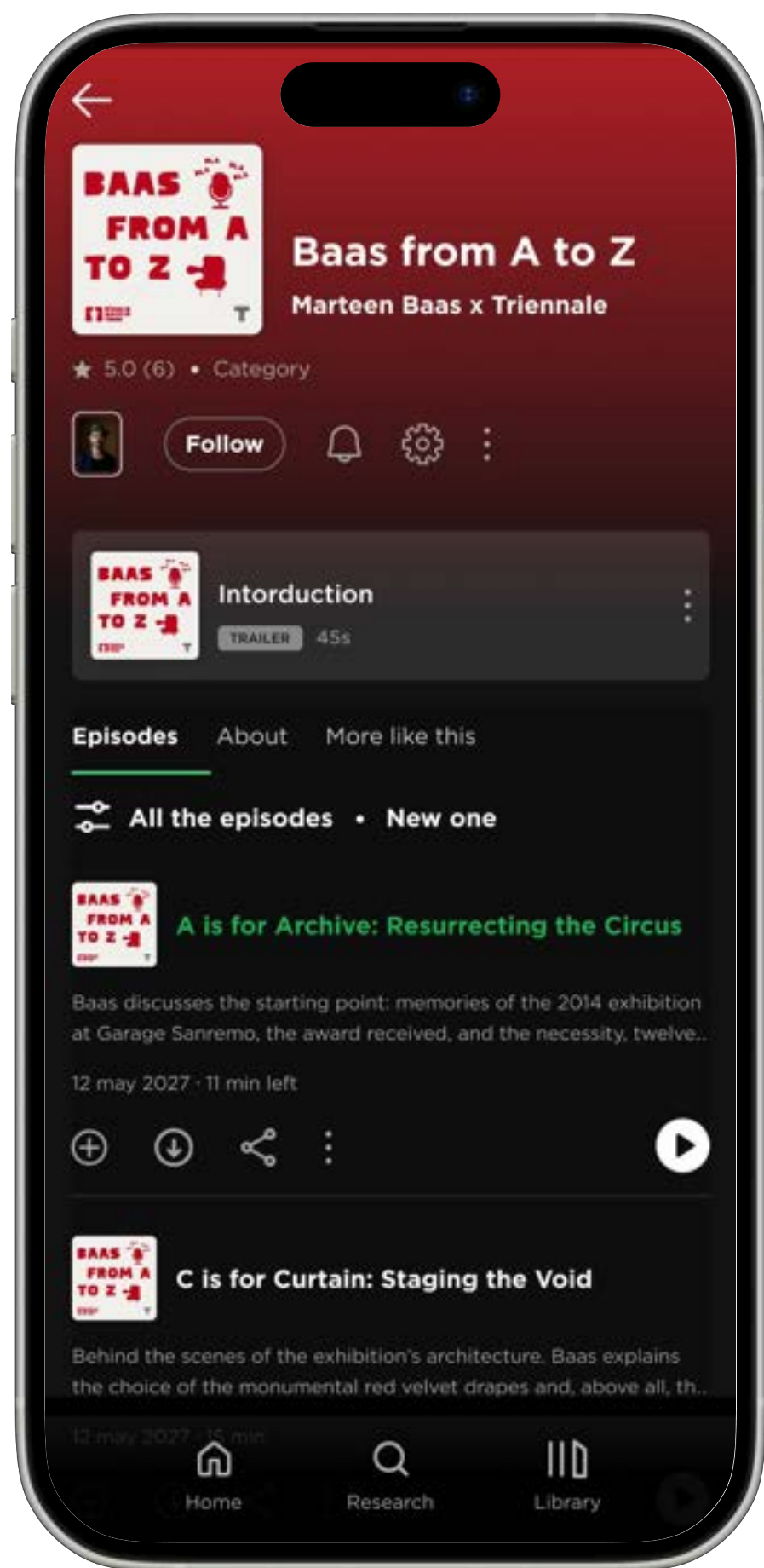
EPISODE 5

O is for Observation: The Invisible Eye

EPISODE 6

Z is for Zoom: From Object to Behavior

PODCAST: BAAS FROM A TO Z



EXHIBITS BROCHURE



EXHIBITS BROCHURE



SECOND LIFE OF THE EXHIBITION

To ensure a sustainable afterlife, the exhibition's **red curtains** will be **donated** to cultural institutions after the closing night. Meanwhile, the **show carousel** will remain at Triennale, finding a permanent home as a kinetic installation in the **garden**, to leave a piece of this design provocation in the house of design.

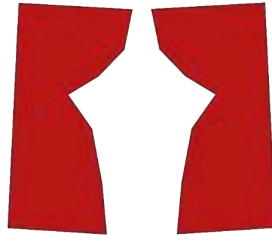


COLOPHON



TEXT FONT:
AKZIDENZ GROTESK

TEXT SIZE:
48 PT



BAAS IS BACK IN TOWN

MILANO DESIGN WEEK
12-18 APRILE 2027
TRIENNALE , MILANO

MILAN DESIGN WEEK
APRIL 12TH-18TH 2027
TRIENNALE, MILAN



A CURA DI
MAARTEN BAAS

**PROGETTO ESPOSITIVO
E ASSISTENZA CURATORIALE**
CAMILLA COSTATO
RONI GOLD
HILA SHAKI
CAMILLA VICARIO
FRANCESCO ZANCHETTA

CREDITI OPERE
MAARTEN BAAS
TEUN HOCKS
JOHN KÖRMELING
BERTJAN POT

PRESTITI E COURTESY
CANOOF GALLERY
CARPENTERS WORKSHOP GALLERY
CENTRAAL MUSEUM UTRECHT
COLLEZIONI PRIVATE
KOOPGOOT ROTTERDAM
LASVIT
MAARTEN BAAS STUDIO

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PARTNER ISTITUZIONALE
TRIENNALE MILANO

CURATED BY
MAARTEN BAAS

**EXHIBITION DESIGN AND
CURATORIAL ASSISTANCE**
CAMILLA COSTATO
RONI GOLD
HILA SHAKI
CAMILLA VICARIO
FRANCESCO ZANCHETTA

ARTWORK CREDITS
MAARTEN BAAS
TEUN HOCKS
JOHN KÖRMELING
BERTJAN POT

LOANS AND COURTESY
CANOOF GALLERY
CARPENTERS WORKSHOP GALLERY
CENTRAAL MUSEUM UTRECHT
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RY THANKS

Camilla Costato, Roni Gold, Hila Shaki, Camilla Vicario, Francesco Zanchetta